AI in the Real World

Data, Power, & Society - Day 28

The Final Project & Updated Presentation Schedule

CMSE 492 (aka CMSE 101) • Fall 2026

Prof. Danny Caballero

Today's Six Digits: 902714



Today

1. **Scaffold 2 is due today** (Fri, Nov 6). Submit it on D2L.
2. **The Final Project** is now fully described. We'll walk through it.
3. **Presentation schedule** has been updated. Check your group's day.
4. **Work time** with your Case Design team.

The Full Case III is due Sun, Nov 8.

We'll be circulating. Ask us anything.

The Final Project

Where You Are in the Case Design

You have built your case one scaffold at a time.

- **Scaffold 1** scoped the problem
- **Scaffold 2** built the evidence base and committed to a design direction
- **Final project:** your team **makes the case** for that design, in writing and in front of the class, and each of you looks back at what you learned

Full instructions: **Final Case Design Project** on the course site.

Three Parts

Part	Who	What	Length
A. Essay	Team	An argumentative essay presenting and defending your design	3000 words minimum
B. Showcase Presentation	Team (everyone speaks)	A sharp, engaging talk about your case	12 min + 3 min questions
C. Cover Letter	Each student	What you learned, how you grew, and the course grade you have earned	About 500 words

Part A: The Essay Is an Argument

Convince a **skeptical, well-informed reader** who has not seen your scaffolds.

- **State a clear thesis.** One sentence: what you propose and why.
- **Present the design precisely.** Specific enough that someone could build it (or enforce it), and someone who disagrees could argue against it.
- **Foreground the DTPA components that carry your argument.** Name the crux, argue for why, and go deep. Treat the rest more briefly.
- **Show the AI literacies at work.** Don't just name them.
- **Take the strongest objection seriously**, not the easiest one.
- **Close critically pragmatic.** Technology is neither the savior nor only a harm.

Part A: Naming vs. Showing a Literacy

Naming (avoid)

Our project uses quantitative literacy because we looked at accuracy numbers.

Showing (aim for)

The vendor reports 94% accuracy, but only 3% of cases in the validation set were positive. A model that flagged no one would score 97%. The number that matters is the false-negative rate, which the vendor does not publish. Our proposal requires it.

Part A: Evidence and Format

- Build from your **Scaffold 2 annotated bibliography**: at least **8 sources**, at least **3 different kinds**
- Every claim traceable to your reference list, in **APA**
- Every number says **where it came from** and **what it was measured on**
- **3000 words minimum**, connected prose, one consistent voice
- Title, team names, and pathway at the top
- **Disclose any AI use**: which tool, and for what

You may **not** turn in the final essay until **after** your group presents.

Part B: The Showcase

12 minutes presenting + 3 minutes of questions. Everyone on the team speaks.

Not your essay read aloud. **One argument, made clearly.**

Section	Time
Hook: a person, a number, or an incident	~1.5 min
The problem or system	~1.5 min
The crux (DTPA + literacy)	~3 min
The proposal	~3.5 min
Risks and trade-offs	~1.5 min
Closing: the one thing to remember	~1 min

8 to 12 slides is usually enough. **Put a source on every slide with a number or claim.**

Part B: Feedback You Will Receive

After each talk, the audience answers three questions:

1. What was the **most convincing** part of this proposal?
2. What is the **biggest weakness** or unanswered question?
3. If you were implementing (or affected by) this proposal, what would you **want to know**?

Your team gets this feedback after the Showcase and uses it for **"Changes after the Showcase"** in the final essay.

The Showcase is not graded on its own, but **completing it is required for a Case Design grade of 3.0 or higher.**

Part C: The Cover Letter

An **individual** letter to Danny, about **500 words**, first person. The last (and most important) Effort & Metacognitive Report.

Section	Words
What you learned from your case design	~125
How you have grown in DTPA and AI literacies (**compare earlier work to later work**)	~150
The course grade you have earned, and why	~225

For the grade: claim a level for **Class Engagement (40%)**, **Case Studies (30%)**, and **Case Design (30%)**, with evidence. Include **your own contribution to the team**.

Final Project Timeline

Date	What
Fri, Dec 4	Essay draft + response to Scaffold 2 feedback (>250 words)
Mon, Dec 7	Showcase Day 1 (3 groups). Slides before class.
Wed, Dec 9	Showcase Day 2 (3 groups). Slides before class.
Fri, Dec 11	Showcase Day 3 (2 groups). Slides before class.
Tue, Dec 15, 11:59pm	Final essay with "Changes after the Showcase" (team) and cover letter (individual)

Your Showcase day will be posted on D2L. **No in-class final exam.**

Presentation Schedule

Updated Presentation Schedule

Groups 05 and 08 are new. Thank you to every group that stepped up.

Date	Day	Presenting Group
Nov 9	Mon	*No presenter: Case Design work time*
Nov 11	Wed	**Group 07** (Education)
Nov 16	Mon	**Group 03** (Education)
Nov 18	Wed	**Group 05** (Retail & Consumer)
Nov 23	Mon	**Group 01** (Athletics & Sports)
Nov 25	Wed	*No presenter: Case Design work time*
Nov 30	Mon	**Group 08** (Athletics & Sport)
Dec 2	Wed	**Group 06** (Healthcare)

Also posted on D2L and in the course schedule.

If You Are Presenting

- **20 minutes** presenting, then **5 minutes** of questions, in the last 25 minutes of class
- **Send your session plan to Danny 3 days before** your day
- **Write the Exit Ticket** for your day
- **Submit your slides** to be posted on D2L *before* your day
- **Individual reflection** (~150 words) is due that Sunday at 11:59pm, *instead of* your case analysis that week

Group 07 presents Wednesday. Your session plan is due to Danny on **Monday** (Nov 9).

Work Time

Use the rest of class with your Case Design team.

- **Submit Scaffold 2** if you haven't yet
- **Finish Full Case III**: it is due Sunday
- **Read the Final Project page** together and decide how to split the essay and the talk
- **Start naming the "crux of the biscuit" (RIP Frank Zappa):** which DTPA component(s) does your design highlight?

We'll be circulating. Ask us anything.

No Exit Ticket Today

- Exit Tickets are **only after Wednesday's class**.
- **No Exit Ticket today.**

Deadlines

- **Fri, Nov 6:** Case Design Scaffold 2 due (1500 words, plus response to Scaffold 1 feedback, >250 words)
- **Sun, Nov 8:** Full Case III (complete) due
- **Sun, Nov 8:** Week 10 Individual Effort & Metacognitive Report due
- **Sun, Nov 8:** Week 11 Forum Post due (**Data**, reflecting on your semester's work)
- **Wed, Nov 11:** Group 07 presents
- **Fri, Dec 4:** Essay draft + response to Scaffold 2 feedback due